

HUMAN RESOURCE

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INT. OFFICE - NIGHT

RINGING rattles off glass meeting rooms hued in greens and reds. But no Team Members are at their desks.

Not that they're really *theirs*. Hüm Automations features an open-plan office, with a range of flexible spaces for both Work and Life...

RING

...a snack-stocked kitchen, a sage-scented meditation room, and a black marble coffee bar with a barista named Kevin.

RING

But it's too late for Kevin now. And the kitchen's closed too.

Yet BASS THUMPS the floors. Punctured only by--

RINGING

from behind rows of lush bamboo, where sleek white standing desks are empty. Except, of course:

SHAE'S DESK

with its motivational sticky notes and pinned polaroids of Team Members embracing at corporate retreats...

...and the Cisco 7800 shrieking its industry-leading:

RING--

SHAE (29, accessible in a company fleece) snaps it up.

SHAE
HR, this is--

RAM (PHONE)
Shae.

The voice ripples down her spine.

RAM (PHONE) (CONT'D)
I know what you're doing.

She swirls her chair to scan the office...but it's empty.

As she spins back--

Her laptop SNAPS shut.

RAM, the 40ish Chief Operating Officer, looms over her.

RAM
Time to go.

She opens her mouth to protest.

But he just shakes his head and turns away...

...then bends forward. She exhales.

Then hops on his back for a piggyback ride down the hall.

RAM
Relax. You've practiced enough.
You're gonna crush it tomorrow.

BASS becomes MUSIC as Ram opens the door to a:

PARTY

with a bountiful buffet, a bouncing dance floor, and a gaggle of buzzed TEAMMATES. And on stage:

GUS HÜM (Founder & CEO) pacing in plain black.

GUS
--founded this company with one
simple idea: that our tools will
make us *more human* - not less.

At the buffet, THE PARTNER (60s, cargo shorts) gnashes buffalo wings. Teeth ripping sticky red flesh from the bone.

GUS (CONT'D)
That software can handle the noise,
so people can do the work.
(catching Partner's eye)
And that's only possible with the
continued support of Olympus
Capital. So, thank you.

The Partner returns a saucy smile, hands a clean bone to his hulking CONSULTANT beside him. Licks his fingers.

GUS (CONT'D)
And thank you to everyone here.
Because the real value of this
place isn't products. It's *people*.

The Partner stops licking.

Down the buffet, Shae discreetly wraps shrimp in a napkin.

SHAE'S DESK - MINUTES LATER

Shae pops open her laptop, revealing a PowerPoint deck (ShaeValue.ppt). Slides detailing 8 years of contributions and a convincing case for promotion to Vice President.

She digs into the shrimp. And clicks through the slides.

Each CLICK advancing a slide. Each slide a moment of her evening in an **OPENING SEQUENCE**:

- CLICK. Shae reviews her bio page.
- CLICK. Shae prints 12 copies.
- CLICK. A wheel rotates slowly.
- CLICK. Exercise bike. Going nowhere. Deck propped on bar.
- CLICK. Shae washes her face.
- CLICK. Shae drops her head on a pillow.
- CLICK. Shae turns off the lights.

SEQUENCE ENDS as she straps on her sleep-mask.

Shae turns over. Sinks into the pillow. Drifting off, until--
DING!

Shae sits up, confused. Peels off the sleep-mask.

Carefully tiptoes to door...

...cracks it, and peeks out to the:

MAIN FLOOR

of the OFFICE just as Gus races off the elevator.

He zips by a door marked MEDITATION ROOM but doesn't see:

Shae peering through the crack, from inside.

MEDITATION ROOM

Once he's out of sight, Shae exhales.

Through the door, a sliver of light shines on the front page of her deck, just the middle chunk of her title (Head of Human Resources), illuminating:

HUMAN RESOURCE

Shae closes the door. Room goes dark, leaving the words unreadable. She goes back to sleep.

GUS'S OFFICE - SAME

Gus hurries into his office and finds:

THE PARTNER (O.S.)
Party's over, Gus.

The Partner at his desk, licking an ice cream cone.

THE PARTNER (CONT'D)
It was a cute speech. But you know
the new product is the only reason
Olympus invested in this company.

The hulking CONSULTANT rises from the sofa. Gus trembles.

THE PARTNER (CONT'D)
Everything else is replaceable.
(lick)
Especially you.

GUS
There is no product without me.

THE PARTNER
Not yet.

The Consultant LOCKS the door behind Gus.

BLOOD DRIPS

as rare steak is sliced the next morning.

INT. OFFICE - KITCHEN - DAY

REVEAL steak being sliced in the breakfast taco buffet.

Shae joins two female JAMIES in line.

JAMIE 1	JAMIE 2
Morning Shae Shae!	Morning Shae Shae!

SHAE
Morning, Jamies.

JAMIE 1
Today the day?

Shae shrugs, coy, as they walk the taco line.

JAMIE 2
You hear about Laura?

SHAE

Laura O?

JAMIE 2

No, Laura with the--

Jamie gestures to her face area. *Ohh.*

JAMIE 2

Yeah. BetaWave just made her VP.

SHAE

Good for her. Like, *really* good.
Especially for her. You know, I
 basically taught her everything.
 And honestly--
 (overstuffing tortilla)
 --she wasn't even that good.

JAMIE 2

Good enough to be a Vice President.

SHAE

Yeah. Pulling 80 hours a week.

JAMIE 1

Looks like she's at the beach.

Jamie whips out a phone to reveal Laura's Instagram post:
 magic hour at the beach - framed by watercolor villas.

SHAE

Is that in Italy? Lucky.

JAMIE 1

You can go to the beach, Shae.

SHAE

Nice try. But people need me.

Jamies' eyes roll as--

DARA (O.S.)

Shae? I need you.

SHAE'S DESK - MINUTES LATER

Shae focuses on her PowerPoint.

Meanwhile, baby associate DARA (23, sleeves over wrists)
 stands at her shoulder, anxious.

Behind them, the WHITE BOARD reads:

Q1: LEAN IN

DARA

--and he was weird about it. Like *I* was being weird. So should I talk to him again? Or is *that* weird?

SHAE

It's only weird if you're weird. And you're not weird, Dara. You're a badass *adult* woman who knows what she's doing.

DARA

Right. And what am I doing?

Dara lifts a thumbnail to her teeth - but Shae pulls it away without even looking.

DARA (CONT'D)

Please just tell me what to do. I don't wanna get yelled at again.

SHAE

(halting, not turning)

Wait. He *yelled* at you?

DARA

I just said that.

SHAE

No. You said he was weird about it.

(typing again with force)

That he made you feel like *you* were being weird. But you never said that he *yelled* at you...Dara...

Shae stabs Ctrl+S and swings to Dara. Gently:

SHAE (CONT'D)

...did he yell at you?

ZEKI (PRE-LAP)

I asked her to do her job.

ZEKI'S DESK - LATER

Shae patiently sits with the impatiently coding ZEKI (30s).

SHAE

Right. But the thing is, that's not *your* job. If you have concerns with an HR associate, you come to me.

ZEKI

I'm not concerned about your mini-me, Shae. I'm concerned about...*me*.

SHAE

Why? Ram said you're irreplaceable.

ZEKI

Everyone is replaceable. You know what we build here.

(beat, turning)

And I can't lose this job.

Shae follows his nervous eyes to a framed photo of his family in Turkey. She overdoes a sympathetic sigh.

SHAE

Listen, I get it--

ZEKI

No. You don't. You work here because you *can*. I work here because I'm *temporarily permitted*. If I don't get another H1-B...

SHAE

Zeki. If the company promised you a Green Card, they'll handle it.

ZEKI

But you basically *are* this company, Shae. Why can't you handle it?

SHAE

Because that's above my head.

She smirks. *For now*. Then struts off. Leaving Zeki confused.

COFFEE BAR - MINUTES LATER

Hunky barista KEVIN preps an iced latte for an incoming Shae.

SHAE

My angel. Can you actually make it hot for me today?

KEVIN

But you're already on fire.

She blushes and pulls out her phone, as he foams her milk.

SHAE

I didn't see you at the party.

KEVIN

Oh I thought that was for like,
actual employees.

SHAE

Kevin. You're part of the family.

Just then, Shae sees a beach pic on her phone. Same beach as Laura's instagram. But it's not Laura. It's a DAD with a teen girl - in a message chain with someone named NINA.

KEVIN

Is that your sister?

SHAE

Only half. But I guess everyone
prefers the new and improved model.
(under breath)
He really can't find another beach?

As she steams, he slides her a STEAMING LATTE under eye-line.

KEVIN

There's taro buns in the kitchen.
If you haven't had your yogurt yet.

SHAE

What would I do without you?

KEVIN

Spend less time in the office?

She SNORTS foam. *Funny*. Then she marches off with a smile...

...leaving Kevin rolling his eyes. He wasn't joking.

SHAE (PRE-LAP)

The true value of a company is its
people. And that's my job--

CONFERENCE ROOM - LATER

Shae recites her spiel as she places printed POWERPOINT DECKS
around a table. Muffins too.

SHAE (CONT'D)

--building a home for human capital
to flourish. And as Vice President--

DOOR OPENS for--

SHAE

Ram?

Ram collapses onto the sofa. Phone falls to the floor.

SHAE

What's going on? This is the most important meeting of my life. Are you seriously hungover right now?

RAM

Shae. It's a bloodbath.

SHAE

Well then stop doing coke with Grady! Just take some advil or something before Gus gets here.

RAM

Gus is never coming back here. As of today, he's *persona non grata*.

SHAE

Is that in Italy?
(under breath)
Is everyone at the beach?

Shae grabs a muffin for a nervous bite--

RAM

No. Shae. I mean: Gus is dead--

--SPRAYS MUFFIN before Ram can finish--

RAM (CONT'D)

--to us. Olympus Capital *terminated* him last night.

SHAE

What. They can't do that.

RAM

They own 100% of our equity now.
They can do whatever they want.

Finally, Shae picks up Ram's phone. NEWS ARTICLE on screen:

BLOODBATH! TECH MARKET MELTS DOWN, FIRMS SCRAMBLE TO SURVIVE

RAM (CONT'D)

And they want to restructure.
As of this morning, the firm's controlling shares have been transferred to some special purpose LLC to oversee the transition.

DING!

SHAE
What. Who's Elsie?

COLD AIR WHOOSHES inside as Ram cracks the door to see:

ELLSIE

gliding off the elevator with icy efficiency. Ageless in a tailored suit, she assesses her new domain. Then enters Gus's office like a parasite infecting its host.

Ram scurries over to meet his new boss...

...leaving Shae alone with her "Shae Value" deck. Fuck.

MEDITATION ROOM

Shae rushes in. Stashes her personal items (clothes, sheets, toiletries) in the closet. Then finds her Shae Value deck. She RIPS it in half. Then again. Again. Again.

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - LATER

Shae pretends to work. But watches Ellsie - in her new office - issue Ram instructions while purging Gus's personal items.

DARA (O.S.)
Shae. Something's wrong.

Dara rolls her chair up. Eyes wide with panic.

SHAE
What? Nothing's wrong.

DARA
But Grady says we're getting gutted.

SHAE
Dara, please. Grady's a clinical moron. We only hired him because of his dad's hedge fund.

Sales guy GRADY (fleece vest, beautiful hair) leans over.

GRADY
And who do you think told me, Shae?
(reading text on phone)
He said we're "fat on the belly and the butcher's on the way".

Shae turns to him with sympathy: *he texted you that?*

Dara's eyes well up. Shae wraps her up like a camp counselor.

SHAE

Relax. Ram can handle this.

Ram emerges. Followed by his handler, Ellsie.

RAM

Morning everyone. Um. I know things seem...*frantic* recently. But we have some exciting updates for you about the future of this company--

ELLSIE

This company is insolvent.

(beat)

I will be salvaging any valuable assets prior to liquidation. Carry on your assigned tasks as normal.

Everyone looks at Shae. Dara pulls at her sweater like a kid in the supermarket: *say something!*

SHAE

But I thought we were doing well.

ELLSIE

At what?

(off Shae's glitch)

What do you do?

SHAE

Oh. We're a global provider of--

ELLSIE

No. What does this company do?

Shae stammers. Ellsie scans the crowd for another answer...

ZEKI

We build and sell automated B2C engagement software. Like chatbots. Customer service phone trees.

Ellsie assesses him. Then points to Gus's old office. Zeki quickly complies. Ellsie turns to follow him, but--

SHAE

But we're more than that. We have a really special culture here.

ELLSIE

Your culture is a luxury. And a relic of low interest rates.

SHAE
Well I'm sorry but--

ELLSIE
Why? Did you do something wrong?

SHAE
No, it's just - if you destroy the culture, all the best people will leave. It'll be a bloodbath.

ELLSIE
(processing, then)
Okay. I appreciate the insight.

Ellsie proceeds to her new office to meet Zeki.

Shae circles around to see: everyone smiling. It's a win!

A WEEK LATER

Shae circles around to see: an emptying office. It's a--

RAM (O.S.)
--bloodbath.

Ram slumps in a chair. Grady and the Jamies at nearby desks.

SHAE
Relax. She hasn't fired anyone yet.

JAMIE 1
She's smoking us out. Everyone who can get another job is leaving.

SHAE
(noticing Dara listening)
Great. So she needs us.

JAMIE 2
She's here to gut us. We need her.

GRADY
I don't need her.

SHAE
Grady. You have a DUI.

GRADY
CUI. And Jamie's thing is worse!

JAMIE 1
You told him?

JAMIE 2
You told him?

SHAE
Jamies, please! What can we do?

JAMIE 1
Quit before it's too late?

JAMIE 2
No. If we get fired, we can get
severance *and* unemployment.

Dara chomps her nail and runs off. Shae chases after.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - CONTINUOUS

Shae finds Dara stepping up on a MAINTENANCE LADDER.

SHAE
Where do you think you're going?

Dara looks up - from the first floor, the ladder goes up forever...but not back down to ground level. She exhales and sinks down, against the ladder. Shae wraps her shivering body in a cardigan. Sits.

DARA
What am I gonna tell my family?

SHAE
They'll understand. It's not like
they replaced you with another
daughter or anything.

DARA
Shae. This isn't about you.

SHAE
Sorry, I mean: you have value.
Someone will see that.

DARA
That's easy for you to say. You're
already...*there*. And I'm what?
Going back to Michigan to be
another New York burnout?

Dara tries to bite a pinky - but Shae gently takes her hand.

SHAE
Dara. I will die before I let you
go back to Michigan.

DARA
Shae. *This isn't about you.*

INT. OFFICE - LATER

Shae marches to Gus's old office. Ram scrambling behind her.

RAM
--please don't. She's only keeping
me to keep things calm. And I can't
get fired. I have nowhere to go!

SHAE
I'm not scared of her.

RAM
Well maybe you should be.

~~GUS'S OFFICE~~ ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Shae surprises Ellsie at her desk. Ram at Shae's heels.

RAM
I told her not to--

ELLSIE
Leave.

Shae gulps and follows Ram out--

ELLSIE
Not you.

Both turn back. Ellsie nods to Ram, who gets it. Leaves.

SHAE
It's Elsie, right?

ELLSIE
There are two L's.

Ellsie sits at her computer. Shae notices a trashbag with Gus's stuff. And a POTTED PLANT with brown, crispy leaves.

SHAE
Sure. Anyway. I uh, wanted to see
if you wanted to get some coffee?
Kevin is...*amazing*.

ELLSIE
A Keurig can do his job.

SHAE
Right. Okay. Well, this is actually
what I wanted to talk about. You
have such a clear communication--

ELLSIE
This a problem?

SHAE
No, no. That's actually the good
part. And not really the point--

ELLSIE
Then why did you say it?

SHAE
To cushion the critical feedback.
(miming a sandwich)
It's uh, it's a compliment sandwich.

ELLSIE
It's a condescending waste of time.

SHAE
It's our culture. And I told you if
you destroy it, people will leave.

ELLSIE
And I told you I appreciated the
insight. Those voluntary departures
lowered our severance liabilities.

GASP. She is here to gut them. But it gets worse.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Yet liabilities remain.

Ellsie finally turns her full attention to Shae. Uh oh.

ELLSIE
Shae. What do you do?
(anticipating)
Not your title. When you are at
your desk, what do you actually do?

SHAE
Sorry, I--

ELLSIE
Stop apologizing and answer me.

SHAE
I do people stuff! Okay? I get them
to show up. I get them to *care*. And
that's irreplaceable. And it's why,
before you got here, they were gonna
promote me to Vice President!

Ellsie looks her up and down with utter pity.

ELLSIE

Shae. They were never going to make you a Vice President.

SHAE

What. I've given my life--

ELLSIE

Exactly. Why would they pay extra?

SHAE

You don't understand. I basically, like, *am* this company.

ELLSIE

No. You don't understand.

Ellsie backs the terrified Shae to the door...

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

You are rented labor trained to accept validation, frivolity, and a false sense of security in lieu of material compensation.

...until Shae is in the hall.

ELLSIE

I am the company now.

Ellsie SLAMS the door on her face. Then hears a SQUEAK.

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - NIGHT

SQUEAKING of Shae's mouse as she furiously pages through apartment listings. She changes the price filter. NO RESULTS.

The floor is silent. It's late. But Ellsie's still in her office, so Shae can't "go home" yet.

THUMP. Shae hears the sound coming from Ellsie's office.

THUMP. Shae approaches carefully. The blinds are drawn, but light bleeds through a crack. And now she hears:

THUMP. HISS. THUMP. HISS. THUMP. HISS.

Shae leans in. Through the gap:

A SHADOW moving in rhythm. A BARE FOOT stomping on the ground repeatedly. It's fucking weird. THUMP. HISS. THUMP. HISS.

As Shae leans closer, the sounds halt and--

ELLSIE'S EYE fills the crack.

Shae JOLTS back. Spins around and races toward:

RAM'S OFFICE

and bolts inside. Closes the door. Catches her breath.

RAM (O.S.)
Are you okay?

Shae JUMPS. She didn't realize Ram was there.

SHAE
Yeah. She's just...doing something
in there.

She turns and sees Ram laying on the sofa. Looking pathetic.

SHAE
Are you okay?

RAM
Gus won't return my calls. Do you
think he hates me for staying?

SHAE
(sitting, sympathetic)
*Hate you? He's just in Bali or
whatever. But you know he loves
you. I mean, Ram, he made you COO.*

RAM
Please. You know I only got the job
because Doug got caught on that
website, and I...I had just *been*
here forever. I never knew what I
was doing. I'm an imposter.
(jumping her protest)
It's okay. That's my thing. I'm
good at being seen as good. But
that only works in a bull market.
And now, well...the bear is here.

SHAE
Don't call her that. That's sexist.

RAM
The bear market, Shae. No one's
buying my act in a downturn. But
you, you can still get out of here.

Shae shakes her head, on the verge of tears.

RAM

You have to. At least interview--

SHAE

I did! I applied to 17 companies. I emailed every HR person I know. 4 ignored me. 13 bounced back.

RAM

Because you had the wrong emails?

SHAE

Because they got fired, Ram! No one wants them. No one wants *me*. I thought this was all I knew how to do. But apparently I'm not even good at it. Just good at *seeming good*--
(hearing it now)
Oh my god. Ram. I'm the imposter.

Ram waves his hands: no!

SHAE

Seriously think about it. We played one drunk game of laser tag like six years ago. Then things went well and you gave me all this credit because you *liked* me. Then once you became my mentor or whatever, you *had* to pretend I was good. Because if I wasn't, what would it say about you?

RAM

Jesus, Shae. That's sick.

SHAE

It's true! And now I'm locked in. I gave my whole life to advance here. And all the sudden, here is over and I can never get *there*?

Ram looks around. Where?

MEDITATION ROOM - MINUTES LATER

Shae dribbles in. Head down like charlie brown. Kills the lights. Flops onto the made-up sofa.

In the darkness, she whimpers into the pillow.

ELLSIE (O.S.)

So. This really is your home.

LIGHTS ON. Ellsie sits calmly in the corner.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

I've never seen someone actually
bring their *whole self* to work.

SHAE

It's temporary. The market is just
crazy. And my roommate moved out--
(off Ellsie's blank stare)
And technically there's no rule
against it. And I like it here. I
have everything I need. For free.

ELLSIE

Nothing is free.

SHAE

Sure. I guess like, *metaphorically*.

ELLSIE

I don't use metaphors on company
time. Food, facilities, freezing
your eggs. The perks are here to
keep you here. And here you are.

SHAE

And? Why are you here?

ELLSIE

My job is to invest in distressed
assets, strip their liabilities,
and maximize their value.

Shae deflates onto a yoga ball, which deflates.

SHAE

I get it. I'm the liability.

ELLSIE

No, Shae. You're just distressed.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE - MINUTES LATER

In pajamas, Shae watches Ellsie use gardening scissors to
SNIP dead leaves off the plant. She kept it. Nice.

ELLSIE

Gus was a fine engineer, but he
failed to deliver the product he
promised. Instead wasting resources
on diversions like...email chains.
Birthday cake. Meetings.

SHAE

We're having brainstorming sessions on how to trim back on those.

ELLSIE

We have to trim *everything* if this firm is going to survive, Shae.

SNIP. Ellsie looks up at an ORG CHART on the wall. A massive web of faces, names, and titles. SNIP.

ELLSIE

It will be a difficult transition. That's why I'm retaining Ram as Interim CEO. But I still need an *additional resource* to help acclimate the headcount to our new economic reality. Someone with a bit of...*human touch*.

Shae quietly GASPS. But doesn't respond. Ellsie sits.

ELLSIE

Shae. I'm expressing a need for your services. This is the part when you tell me what you want.

SHAE

Well maybe I can review the details first and then we can circle back?

ELLSIE

There is no circle. Just a line from your supply to my demand. So, show me the line.

SHAE

Vice President.

Ellsie's surprised at the quick response. But squints. *Why?*

SHAE

Because that's how I get there.

Ellsie looks around. *Where?*

SHAE

There. Where I've made it. Where I have security. Where I can just...*go to the beach* without worrying about falling behind, or being replaced.

ELLSIE

Employees can always be replaced.

SHAE
Aren't you an Olympus employee?

ELLSIE
The Partners at Olympus are both my
shareholders and clients. But I
remain an independent entity. As I
told you before:
(beat)
I am the company.

Oh. Shae realizes that was never a metaphor.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
I know it pains everyone to admit,
but Mitt Romney was right.

Ellsie leans in, practically purring.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
About corporations being people.
(savoring the concept)
We're all just *independent agents*
transacting value.
(eyes flashing)
And Shae, I see your value.

GASP. It's everything Shae's ever wanted to hear.

ELLSIE
In fact, I'd like to discuss an
investment opportunity.

SHAE
An investment in what?

ELLSIE
You.

Ellsie slides over an EQUITY AGREEMENT. Shae blinks.

ELLSIE
My Analyst can help with the details.

Ellsie rises and opens a closet door.

CLOSET - MOMENTS LATER

Shae sits with a red-eyed, neck-tatted ANALYST (late 20s),
churning out spreadsheets. Monitors flashing manically.

SHAE
Is this a bad time?

ANALYST

Market's in a death spiral. Firms
are being stripped for parts.

(smile)

No better time for private equity.

He shakes a container with a MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

ANALYST

Meal replacement? Their Russian
portfolio company makes it.

SHAE

I'm okay. Is that like Soylent?

ANALYST

Not according to the FDA.

He scoops GREEN POWDER into water. Stirs. Sips.

ANALYST

So. She's gonna invest in you.

SHAE

Maybe. Unless it's a bad idea?

ANALYST

It's a great idea. As long as you
know what you're doing.

SHAE

Totally. And what am I doing?

ANALYST

Selling shares in yourself. So you
get cash now. And she gets a stake
in your future value. You
understand how equity works?

SHAE

That's like stock, right?

He nods.

SHAE

Then no.

ANALYST

Okay. Let's start with the basics.

He jumps to his feet.

ANALYST (CONT'D)

Finance...is like time travel.

He waits for this to land. It doesn't.

ANALYST (CONT'D)

Think about your student loans. You borrow money from the future to pay for school in the present. But you have to pay it back no matter what. So the lender doesn't care about you beyond your ability to pay.

SHAE

They're not *invested* in me.

ANALYST

Bingo. But with equity, you don't pay anything back. Your shares rise in value as you rise in value. So development and growth are in your investor's best interest. Got it?

SHAE

For sure. 100%. It's just that, it doesn't really make any sense.

ANALYST

That's the beauty of finance, Shae. It doesn't need to make *sense*.
(eyes twinkling)
It just needs to make *money*. And you just need to create value.

SHAE

Don't I have value...*inside me*?

ANALYST

I guess. But she doesn't care what you are. What matters is what you do. Exploit underutilized resources. And find anyway possible to grow assets or cut liabilities. It's a simple formula.

He scribbles on a pad: EQUITY = ASSETS - LIABILITIES.

ANALYST (CONT'D)

That's your valuation. Benchmarked against expectation of course.

SHAE

But how does she set expectations? We can't see the future.

ANALYST

But we *can* simulate it in a model.

SHAE
In our minds?

ANALYST
In Excel.

He pops open some spreadsheets. She's overwhelmed.
He shakes the container of GREEN POWDER. It helps!

CUT TO:

30-50 MINUTES LATER

Shae's bopping around on her toes. Really getting it now.

SHAE
Finance is like time travel!

Analyst pumps his fist. Yeah!

SHAE
It doesn't need to make sense.

Analyst gives PRAYER HANDS and BOWS – preach!

SHAE (CONT'D)
I can calculate my present value by
estimating my assets, liabilities,
and future growth expectations!

Shae takes a big gulp of green drink.

ANALYST
So. Shae. How much are you worth?

He pulls up a spreadsheet: SHAE-VALUE.xlsx.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - NEXT MORNING

The SHAE-VALUE excel sheet on her monitor.

Shae's alone. Clearly up all night. Green still on her lips.

She peeks at an old copy of her printed SHAE-VALUE deck.
Compared to the new excel sheet, it looks so quaint.

She tosses it in the trash.

Then turns to her WHITE BOARD. Replaces **Q1: LEAN IN** with-

Q2: LEAN OPERATIONS

The marker SQUEAKS.

INT. OFFICE - BIKE ROOM - THAT MORNING

SQUEAKING on the SPINNING WHEEL of the EXERCISE BIKE. Shae's pumping away. The room has rows of fancy stationary bikes. But she's the only one there.

Screen flashes BELOW PACE. She sips her green drink. Pushes. Spinning the wheel faster and faster with a HISS--

PRE-LAP: HISS. THUMP. HISS. THUMP--

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

THUMP as Ellsie pivots, planting her bare foot.

HISS as she exhales and STRIKES with her opposite fist.

She's doing some kickboxing-style routine. It's rhythmic. And disciplined. And weird. THUMP. HISS. THUMP. HISS--

SERVER ROOM

HISS of servers in long rows...

...leading to a desk in front of a WALL OF MONITORS...

...where Zeki codes. Beside him, a large container of green powder with the MOUSE DOCTOR logo. Fingers TAPPING on keys.

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - A LITTLE LATER

Shae TAPS open LinkedIn on her phone. Checks her new title: Vice President of People Operations. Clicks SHARE. But with who? She opens messages with DAD.

But it's just pics of fucking Nina. And months of "*coming home anytime soon?*" and "*sorry - crazy busy at work*".

COFFEE BAR - SHORTLY AFTER

By the time Shae arrives, Kevin already has an exquisite latte prepared. S on top in foam.

SHAE

Kevin. Are you sucking up to me?

KEVIN

Definitely not. Why? Is it working?

Shae blushes. Turns away, bashful. Notices a light on in:

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

and finds Ellsie SNIPPING dead leaves from Gus's plant. It's still brown, but coming back to life. Nice!

SHAE

Oh. I didn't realize you were here.

ELLSIE

I was just checking on Francis.

SHAE

Francis, nice. So is he like your--

ELLSIE

I need cuts to recurring expenses.

SHAE

Expenses. Sure. For example...

ELLSIE

For example: *lunch*.

SHAE

That...might be tricky for morale.

ELLSIE

Morale is not my concern.

SHAE

But it's mine. And data clearly show correlation with performance.
(getting somewhere)
Plus, it costs us nothing to be attentive to the emotional context.

Ellsie reviews her. Shae is finally speaking her language.

ELLSIE

Fine. Attend to it.

Shae exhales and turns for the door.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

But there will be no lunch.

GRADY (PRE-LAP)

So we just *pay* for it ourselves?

KITCHEN - LUNCHTIME

Dara, Grady, & Jamies unpack delivery. Shae sips green drink.

SHAE

We were always paying, Grady. The lunch money came out of the employee discretionary budget. Money that *could've* gone to you.

JAMIE 1

Well where's it going now?

SHAE

The balance sheet. To pay for us.

DARA

That doesn't make any sense.

SHAE

If it's saving our jobs, does it really need to make sense?

JAMIE 1

Yes.

JAMIE 2

Yes.

Dara raises her fingernail to teeth.

SHAE

I told you everything is fine.
(pulling Dara's hand away)
Why are you so worried?
(off Dara's shrug)
Then stop worrying. I'm not letting anyone get fired. She *invested* in me to manage people stuff. I just need to prove my value first. You know, show her what she paid for.

Grady's face pinches. Ew.

SHAE (CONT'D)

I mean my human touch.

JAMIE 1

Ew.

JAMIE 2

Ew.

SHAE

What I'm doing is not gross! It's *innovative*. And it gives me real influence. I can protect you. Especially once I'm inside her--

Everyone EWWs.

SHAE (CONT'D)
 --her circle of trust! And budget.
 Guys. *No one wants us*. Our only
 option is adapting to the new Hüm.

GRADY
 I miss the old Hüm. Gus had a boat.

SHAE
 Yeah? Well when was the last time
 anyone even heard from Gus?

Everyone looks at each other: she's right.

RAM (PRE-LAP)
 Gus.

RAM'S OFFICE - SAME

Ram leaves Gus a voicemail.

RAM (CONT'D)
 Trying you again. I guess you're
 not using your phone in Bali
 or whatever. But I need to talk--

SQUEAK! Ram sees a mouse and SQUEALS! He runs onto the:

MAIN FLOOR

and BUMPS right into Shae. She spills green juice on herself.

WHAT THE FUCK RAM?

RAM
 Sorry! There was a mouse.

Just then a MOUSE races over Shae's feet and into the:

SERVER ROOM

with Shae and Ram chasing behind.

BUZZ! They look around. Then down. The mouse!

Electrocuted by some homemade mouse trap. It's horrifying.

ZEKI (O.S.)
 Shae? What are you doing?

Zeki looks over from his desk, sipping green drink.

SHAE

What are you doing?

ZEKI

Oh. They love the heat in here. And the old traps suck. I made these from laptop batteries.

(proud, then turning away)

But why am I explaining myself?
I don't answer to either of you.

RAM

You don't?

SHAE

Listen, I know you're still upset about the Green Card thing--

RAM

You promised him a Green Card?

ZEKI

This isn't about you, Shae. You just *really* can't be here. Really.

Then Shae notices: Ram staring at a monitor. It's...

RAM

GUS?

Gus. He's been on video conference this whole time.

RAM (CONT'D)

What the hell are you doing here? I thought you were in Bali.

ZEKI

He *is* in Bali. And the audio isn't working right now. I'm just pulling some of his old code.

SHAE

So he's working remotely?

ZEKI

It's just for the new product.

RAM

What new product?

SHAE

What new product?

ELLSIE (O.S.)

The product is in stealth mode.

ELLSIE appears behind them. AH!

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Intellectual property is at high
risk with such a...fluid personnel
situation in the office.

RAM
But I'm supposed to be the CEO.

ELLSIE
Interim CEO. Do you know what
interim means, Ramesh?
(in his face)
It means: *for now*. And for now, you
have one function: *simulating*
continuity. Shae will ensure you do
this and nothing else.

RAM
So she's, what, my boss?

SHAE	ELLSIE
Of course not.	Yes.

Shae slowly turns to a stunned Ram with a grin.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
Shae. With me.

HALLWAY - A MINUTE LATER

Shae chases behind Ellsie, updating her.

SHAE
--lunch is done. Same with cleaning
contracts. I figured we can just,
you know, tidy up after ourselves.

Ellsie stops at a bathroom. Stares at her. It's weird.

SHAE
What's...happening right now?

ELLSIE
I'm pleased. And acknowledging you,
as I've seen you do with others.

SHAE
But you're not smiling.
(getting nothing)
You know, a little human touch goes
a long way.

Shae demonstrates a smile. Ellsie nods in recognition. Noted.

ELLSIE

Goodbye.

As Ellsie turns, Shae sees she's holding a workout bag.

SHAE

Oh you work out here? I thought I saw you like kickboxing or--

ELLSIE

(turning back, sharp)

That's enough pleasantries. Go do your job, Shae. And stay out of the server room. And leave Zeki alone. Restrict your attention to your circle of competency.

SHAE

...managing resources for humans?

ELLSIE

The humans are the resources. And there are too many.

(off Shae's gulp)

You've been tasked to deal with the people, Shae. So deal with them.

Deep breath. Shae heads off. *I guess this is the job.*

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

Starting with Dara.

PRE-LAP: CRYING

INT. OFFICE - MAIN FLOOR - LATER

Dara's CRYING echoes across the main floor.

Grady exchanges a look with the Jamies. *What's going on?*

MEETING ROOM

Dara sniffles. Shae's lap is covered in tissues.

DARA

I just don't understand. You said everything is fine. I mean, she's giving you a bonus.

SHAE

It's not a bonus. It's equity. She's investing in my future value.

DARA
But what about *our* value?

Shae thinks. Then sees Team Members watching from outside.
Their distressed faces.

LIGHTBULB.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. OFFICE - ELLSIE'S OFFICE - NEXT DAY

Those same distressed faces. On a printed slide deck. Titled:
HUMAN CAPITAL: INVESTING IN PEOPLE

ELLSIE (O.S.)
But I don't want them.

Ellsie looks across at Shae and the Analyst. They've been up
all night. Red eyes. Green lips.

SHAE
No one does. That's the point.
They're distressed assets. And you--

ELLSIE
I know what I do, Shae.

SHAE
Then it would be irresponsible not
to at least review the opportunity.
Check the ROI projections on 12.

Ellsie reluctantly flips to real data. Hm. Peeks at Analyst.

ELLSIE
You taught her to do this?

SHAE
You did. I've been listening to
everything you've said since you
stepped into the office.

Ellsie gives her a beat of eye contact.

ANALYST
Plus, we already have a benchmark.

SHAE
Which is going well, right?

Another beat of eye contact. Ellsie turns to the Analyst.

ELLSIE
Bottom line?

ANALYST
The labor market's bottoming out.
And you'd be buying at the bottom.
If it were me, I'd do it.

SHAE
Same. Not that you're asking. Or I
have the money.

ELLSIE
But if I was. And you did?

SHAE
Then yes. Of course. If you were to
give me the money, I would 100%
invest it in these people.

Ellsie processes. Shae leans forward for the final push:

SHAE
Listen. We can get more out of them
than anyone else. Because we know
what they're worth. Not just who
they are now, but what they can do
with more resources and training.
They have untapped value. Trust me.
They have value...*inside them*.

Ellsie's eyes flicker. It's a beat full of possibility.

ELLSIE
No.

Ellsie pushes the deck away.

ELLSIE
Olympus wants us gone by Q4.
Proceed with terminations. I need
20% of headcount gone by EOW.

Shae opens to protest but--

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
I have shareholders too, Shae. And
once the product is finished, they
expect this office to be vacated.

Shae sighs. Then looks at the ORG CHART until...LIGHTBULB.

SHAE
What if we don't need an office?

Ellsie slightly cocks her head. Shae smirks.

THE PARTNER (PRE-LAP)
Remote Only?

ELLSIE'S OFFICE - LATER

The Partner sits on the sofa, paging the HUMAN CAPITAL deck and eating cheese puffs. Getting orange on the faces.

THE PARTNER (CONT'D)
Like Gus?

ELLSIE
The model works. And I believe Zeki
can scale the systems by Q4.

The Consultant, standing above him, hands him a wet wipe.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Digitized headcount allows us to
cut office expenses and invest it
directly in this new asset class.
Plus, there are lucrative synergy
opportunities with the portfolio.

The Partner wipes his mouth. Then wipes his hands on the sofa and shoves more puffs in mouth. Speaking through orange mush:

THE PARTNER
Synergy? With what?

Ellsie looks out the window: Shae and the gang pretending not to spy. They scatter.

ELLSIE
I didn't see it before. But these
people have untapped value.
(catching Shae's eyes)
They have value...inside them.

Ellsie smiles. Shae smiles back.

HALLWAY - LATER

Ellsie and Shae march down the hall.

ELLSIE
Olympus is very enthused, Shae. In
fact, they're lending us their
Consultant to expedite the
transitions. The rest is on you.

Ellsie stops. Reviews Shae up and down.

ELLSIE

It will be taxing. Mentally and physically. Do you have a proper training regimen?

SHAE

Um. I bike sometimes.

ELLSIE

A routine combining fitness with real-world applications is a far more efficient use of your time. Perhaps I can share mine.

SHAE

Wait. Are you saying you want to...work out together?

Shae's visibly giddy. Ellsie checks around, embarrassed.

ELLSIE

Don't make a scene.

SHAE

Oh my god. You *care* about me.

ELLSIE

If you die or are otherwise incapacitated, my position devalues. I have a fiduciary obligation to care about you.

SHAE

That's the nicest thing anyone's ever said to me.

YOGA ROOM - LATER

Ellsie reviews Shae's gym shorts and company T-shirt.

ELLSIE

This is too flabby.

SHAE

That's why I'm here.

ELLSIE

I mean the excess material leaves you exposed. Try to strike me.

Ellsie waves her on. Shae winds up and PUNCHES--

Ellsie DUCKS left, THUMPS her foot behind Shae, yanks her shirt then throws her. Shae SMACKS her elbow on the way down.

Ellsie helps Shae up...but quickly releases. Shae falls to the ground. Her eyes fill with tears.

ELLSIE
Stop crying.

SHAE
But it hurts.

ELLSIE
Feeling is a message, Shae. You can ignore it. Like email.

Shae stumbles to her feet. Ellsie waves her to attack.

ELLSIE
Now. Focus on timing.

Shae charges at Ellsie--

ELLSIE
Capture momentum.

Ellsie sidesteps THUMP.

ELLSIE
And impact with leverage.

Ellsie exhales HISS as she POPS Shae behind the knee, who buckles to the ground.

Shae rises off the floor on her own this time. LFG.

MONTAGE BOUNCES AROUND THE OFFICE

SFX: *THUMP/HISS* keeping rhythm.

- SHAE uncaps a green marker. Reviews faces on the ORG CHART.
- THE ANALYST teaches Shae finance.

ANALYST
Find the underutilized resources.

- ELLSIE trains Shae in the yoga room. It's sloppy.

ELLSIE
Exploit every opportunity.

- SHAE pitches the team, deck in hand: INVESTING IN YOU.

SHAE

She sees your long-term value. We
just have to prove her right.

- ZEKI sips green drink, codes with Gus (remote).

ANALYST (V.O.)

Higher risk means higher rewards.

- ELLSIE and Shae train. Shae improving.

ELLSIE

No wasted movements.

- SHAE replaces the real bamboo with fake bamboo.

ANALYST (V.O.)

You can't just be right. Your ideas
have to be perfectly timed.

- THE JAMIES sign their contracts.

ELLSIE (V.O.)

Timing.

- GREEN POWDER stirring in bottles.

ELLSIE (V.O.)

Momentum.

- GRADY sips some green drink. Signs the contract.

ELLSIE (V.O.)

Leverage.

- RAM checks his texts to GUS - all green, unread. His
contract on his desk, still unsigned.

ANALYST (V.O.)

Past performance does not guarantee
future results.

- ELLSIE rushes Shae, Shae takes her down. Ellsie smiles.

SHAE (V.O.)

Timing. Momentum.

- ORG CHART has faces circled in green. Except Dara and Ram.

END MONTAGE AT:

DARA'S DESK - DAY

Shae sits facing Dara.

SHAE (CONT'D)
--leverage.

Dara looks down at her unsigned contract.

SHAE (CONT'D)
This is the time, right now, Dara.
We'll never get a better deal.

DARA
But I still don't understand why
they even want me. Aren't I like
the least valuable person here?

SHAE
It doesn't matter what you are,
Dara. It only matters what you do.

DARA
But I don't know what to do.

Dara lifts a fingernail to her teeth--

Shae gently pulls her hand away.

SHAE
That's why you have me.

Shae hands her the pen.

Dara thinks. Then signs.

INT. OFFICE - ELLSIE'S OFFICE - DAY

Shae THUMPS down a fat stack of contracts.

SHAE
That's everyone except Ram.

ELLSIE
What's wrong with Ram? I thought he
was content playing CEO.

SHAE
Apparently he's not happy with the
remote-only strategy. And
apparently it's *all my fault*. At
least that's what he told Kevin.

ELLSIE
Kevin. Right. About that.

Shae winces. She shouldn't have mentioned Kevin.

SHAE

Can he please stay until Q4?

ELLSIE

Relax. You can keep your Kevin.

Ellsie looks out the window. Spots Ram, spying on them.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

And don't worry about Ram. He'll
make the right decision.

PRE-LAP: DING-A-LING-A-LING

RAM'S OFFICE - SAME

Ram rises off the sofa. Opens his RINGING laptop. It's:

GUS on video call. Tan. Shell necklace. Tropical background.

RAM

Gus? I've been calling you.

GUS (REMOTE)

Sorry, man. The service here sucks.
And I've been so busy with Zeki.

RAM

Well? Have you heard what's been
going on here?

GUS (REMOTE)

Yeah. It's amazing.

Ram cocks his head. It is?

GUS (REMOTE)(CONT'D)

I assumed they'd fire everyone. I
would take this as a win.

RAM

But *remote only*? I mean, we spent
our entire life in this place.

GUS (REMOTE)

Honestly, Ram, I was getting nowhere
in that office. This is literally
the best version of myself I've ever
been. I'm sure you'll be saying the
same thing after you sign the
contract and get out of there.

Ram looks down at his contract.

COFFEE BAR - SAME

Shae watches Ram looking at his contract through the window, as Kevin hands her a mug of boiling tea.

KEVIN

Just be careful, that's--

Absentminded, she takes a HUGE GULP of the boiling tea.

KEVIN

--scalding hot. Are you okay?

SHAE

I'm just sick of Ram. He's such a baby. He should be happy about this. You know he hasn't even talked to me since like Q1?

Shae finally turns her attention back to Kevin. Her cheeks are flatter. Eyes brighter - vaguely greenish.

SHAE (CONT'D)

Anyway, I came to talk to you.

KEVIN

I know. You have to fire me.

SHAE

What. No. Kevin. She promised to keep you until Q4.

KEVIN

And then what? You can't serve coffee to remote workers, Shae.

(off her sigh)

It's okay. Really. I'm good at this job. And other companies still like watching humans make their coffee.

SHAE

(somber)

But what will I do without you?

KEVIN

Spend less time in the office.

She chuckles. But he's dead serious.

SHAE

Sorry. I thought that was a joke.

KEVIN

Why would I joke about that?

SHAE

Um, because we're friends? I mean,
you know what time I eat my yogurt.

KEVIN

Shae. That's the job.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE - A LITTLE LATER

Shae marches right past Ellsie without stopping:

SHAE

We can get a Keurig.

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. OFFICE - BASEMENT - NIGHT

The Consultant pushes a massive box off the elevator...

...down the hall to a white room.

WHITE ROOM - LATER

The Consultant unboxes a machine the size and shape of a tanning bed. On the side, the cartoon MOUSE DOCTOR logo. Same as the green meal replacement bottles.

DING! He looks up.

BASEMENT HALLWAY - SAME

Kevin pops off the elevator, carrying a variety of stolen espresso machine parts and laptop accessories.

He heads toward the back exit...stopping to check storage closets for more valuables.

Then he notices the walk-in freezer. Hm.

FREEZER

COLD AIR hits Kevin as he steps in. Can't find the light.

PHONE FLASHLIGHT ON. He sweeps the shelves until he sees--

ESPRESSO BEANS. Bingo!

He reaches, but KNOCKS it over. BEANS SPRAY everywhere.

WHITE ROOM

The Consultant opens the door and listens to the commotion.

FREEZER

Kevin cleans up the espresso beans.

Sweeping the flashlight across the floor. Soon revealing a:
FROZEN ARM.

CONNECTED TO A FROZEN BODY.

AH! The phone goes flying from his hands.

When he turns back to the door, he sees:

THE CONSULTANT. He SLAMS the door on Kevin's face.

Kevin races to the door in the dark. It's locked. He BANGS.

His phone light on the floor shaking as he BANGS...

BANG BANG BANG.

...until the phone illuminates a badge on the frozen body:

Gus Hüm - Founder & CEO

THE PARTNER (PRE-LAP)

The product exceeds expectations.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. OFFICE - SERVER ROOM - NEXT MORNING

Gus's face on the monitor, in front of Zeki.

THE PARTNER (O.S.)(CONT'D)

When can we expect the rest?

Zeki turns back to Ellsie and The Partner. Nervous.

ZEKI

I need more time--

THE PARTNER

No. You have until Q4. As planned.

Ellsie sees Zeki's green lips, red eyes. She waves the Partner off...to attend to the emotional context.

ELLSIE

What he's saying is that we are on a very tight timeline. If this is a question of motivation--

ZEKI

I don't need more money.

ELLSIE

I'm well aware of what you need, Zeki.

Ellsie looks down at the only personal item on the desk: a photo of Zeki's family in Turkey.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

I'm asking whether you're capable of earning it.

Ellsie pushes the HUMAN CAPITAL deck toward him.

PRE-LAP: DRIBBLING

COFFEE BAR - LATER

A KEURIG dribbles coffee into a mug for Shae.

ELLSIE (O.S.)

I see you've met the new Kevin.

Ellsie approaches. The office is noticeably emptier.

SHAE

Is that...a joke?

ELLSIE

I'm working on engagement strategy.

SHAE

Well, then. I guess he's been optimized for core competencies.

ELLSIE

That is very funny, Shae. And now that we've engaged casually, I have something serious to discuss: your living situation. I know this is difficult for you.

SHAE

No, I get it. If we're going to be working from home, I should probably, you know, *get a home*.

ELLSIE
You already have one.

It's a very sweet moment. But Shae's confused.

SHAE
Is that a metaphor?

ELLSIE
Call it compensation.

Ellsie sets down housekeys on the bar.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
The building is in our portfolio.

Shae looks up at her. And remembers to smile.

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. SHAE'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

ELEVATOR OPENS right into Shae's new place. Dara, Grady, and the Jamies step toward the floor-to-ceiling windows.

GRADY
Whoah. This is it?

SHAE
This is it.

Dara slumps onto an unpacked BOX. The place is unfurnished.

DARA
I can't believe this is really it.
I don't want to be apart.

SHAE
Hey. We'll still be together every day. You'll just be cozy in your pajamas. It'll be great.

GRADY
Yeah. And no more commuting.

JAMIE 1
Yeah.

JAMIE 2
Yeah.

SHAE
Exactly. And trust me, this is going to be the new normal soon. We're basically trailblazers. In fact, we should be *celebrating*.

GRADY
We should be getting drunk.

PRE-LAP: POP

A LITTLE LATER

Grady's pouring prosecco in plastic cups.

Meanwhile, Shae finds Dara lingering by the window. Looking out at the office buildings.

SHAE
Hey. I'm not supposed to say anything, but we're gonna have a party on our last day before Q4. And I need some help planning.

DARA
Really?

Shae smirks. Really.

DARA (CONT'D)
It should be a luau.
(then getting nervous)
But you're not inviting those Olympus guys right?

SHAE
Dara. They're our investors. What are you so worried about?

DARA
(fingers to teeth)
I guess I don't know.

Shae SLAPS Dara's hand away.

SHAE
Then stop worrying.

PRE-LAP: DING!

LATER

The elevator arrives. There are cups everywhere.

Shae hugs everyone as they get on.

JAMIE 1
Night, Shae.

JAMIE 2
Night, Shae.

Shae pinches Dara's cheek. Then Dara gets on the elevator.

DOORS CLOSE on her face.

Shae exhales. Alone for the first time all night.

She drifts to the window. The city below.

In the GLASS: her reflection. And behind her, faint - the lingering shapes of Dara, the Jamies, Grady. Laughing.

She smiles at them. The reflection settles. Just her now. Alone in the frame. She smiles wider. She has everything.

BUZZ.

She finds her phone. A text from Nina. Uch. She tosses it.

Then she looks around. Realizes she has no bed.

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. OFFICE - THAT NIGHT

Shae returns to the office. It's empty. Except a light on in:

RAM'S OFFICE

where Shae finds Ram laying on his sofa.

SHAE
You're still here?

RAM
For now. Soon I'll just be another
face on the screen.

SHAE
This attitude is bad for morale.

She sits unsympathetically next to him. He scoffs.

RAM
And you used to be better at this.

SHAE
This isn't the job, Ram. Coddling
you doesn't generate revenue and it
certainly doesn't cut spending.

RAM
And that's what matters?

SHAE

That's what always mattered. This is a for-profit business. And the fact I even need to say that to *the CEO* is why we're in this mess.

(shaking head, quieter)

I fucking saved you, Ram. I saved this whole fucking company. Yet you sit in here everyday and sulk. And I get that you're mad at me--

RAM

This isn't about you, Shae--

SHAE

Then what is it about?

RAM

Us. It's about us. We're being torn apart. And you don't even care. You don't even acknowledge my existence anymore. You're becoming like her--

SHAE

Is that supposed to be a bad thing?

RAM

Shae. She's basically a robot.

SHAE

That's sexist. If a man acted like that, you'd think he was some devoted genius or something.

RAM

I mean she has no feelings. Or any life outside this office.

SHAE

That's not true. She actually has a boyfriend. Named Francis. It's you who doesn't have a life.

RAM

I know. And I don't want you to make the same mistakes as me. Don't have nowhere else to go.

SHAE

I just got a new apartment.

RAM

Grady said you didn't even unpack. I know you're still sleeping here.

Shae's jaw locks into place. "*Still*"? He knew?

RAM (CONT'D)
I'm not judging you. I'm just
worried, if she finds out--

And then he sees it in her eyes. Ellsie knows. A quiet beat.

SHAE
Yeah. *She* trusts me, Ram. *She* saw
my value when no one else did.

RAM
I get it. And I'm so s--

SHAE
DON'T SAY IT.

Ram's shocked. Shae realizes that was too harsh. She settles.

SHAE
That was unfair. But you didn't do
anything wrong. You're the one who
always pushed for my promotion.

She looks in his eyes. Right? He quivers with guilt.

Oh no.

RAM
Shae. I'm so sorry--

SHAE
Stop apologizing and tell me the
truth. Did you even try?

RAM
I wanted to. I swear. But things
were crazy. And you were our rock.
We knew you'd stay either way and I
guess...I guess we didn't have to.

And now she knows. Ellsie was right.

RAM (CONT'D)
But now, as your friend--

SHAE
We're not friends, Ram. You were my
boss. And now I'm yours. And from
here, I can see you were right the
whole time. You are an imposter.
(rising for door)
And you're transitioning tonight.

RAM
But you said I had until Q4--

SHAE
And I changed my mind. You'll be a
good example for the others. Go see
the Consultant before he leaves.

RAM
No. Please. Something's wrong--

SHAE
He's just going to get your
hardware sorted for remote work.

RAM
--with *her*. She scares me.

SHAE
You're just threatened by a woman
who doesn't buy your bullshit.

RAM
I'm not threatened by you.

Shae stops at the door.

SHAE
Well maybe you should be.

MAIN FLOOR

Shae SLAMS the door behind her. Then marches off, past the:

SERVER ROOM

where Zeki's passed out at his desk. Green on lips.

Beside him, the MOUSE DOCTOR container RATTLES...

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. SHAE'S APARTMENT - A LITTLE LATER

Shae strolls right back into her place. Covered in boxes.

She pulls out her phone, checks her texts from NINA: "*Hey. My mom asked if you're coming home for dad's bday?*".

She dismisses it. Thinks.

Then opens again, responds: *"Hey. Have a huge work thing and I'm moving into my new place. But tell him I'll try to call."*

Thinks. Adds "XOXO". Drops the phone. Takes a deep breath.

Then grabs a boxcutter. Starts unpacking her new life.

INT. OFFICE - BASEMENT HALLWAY - SAME

DING!

Ram steps off the elevator and sees the Consultant waiting outside the white room.

As Ram slowly approaches...he hears:

CHEERY MUSIC playing inside.

INTERCUT:

- SHAE'S APARTMENT

CHEERY MUSIC echoes off empty walls from Shae's phone.

She slices boxes with the boxcutter.

MUSIC STOPS. Phone's dead. As she hunts for a charger, she KNOCKS the boxcutter to the floor with a CLACK.

- SERVER ROOM

CLACK goes the container as it FALLS OVER onto Zeki's desk.

A MOUSE scurries out...covered in green powder...

...right past Zeki's pale, sleeping face.

- WHITE ROOM

Ram follows the Consultant into the cheery music. Sees the:

MACHINE. Like a tanning bed. With a MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

Ram gulps. Turns for the door but--

The Consultant snaps it shut.

PRE-LAP: BUZZING

- SERVER ROOM

BUZZING finally wakes Zeki.

He drops to his knees, follows a trail of green powder...

...to an electric mouse trap...and a MOUSE being electrocuted. Licking green powder off itself. Undisturbed.

Zeki turns to the MOUSE DOCTOR on the meal replacement container. Looks at his half-empty glass. Touches his lips...

...leaving his finger tips green.

He HURLS the glass against the wall.

- SHAE'S APARTMENT

Shae finishes her green drink as she returns with a charger.

STEPS on the boxcutter--

SLICES the bottom of her foot. Doesn't notice.

But does notice the shimmer of her floor-to-ceiling windows. Steps to the gorgeous view...

- SERVER ROOM

Thick green liquid drips down the wall...

- SHAE'S APARTMENT

...blood trails from Shae's foot on her way to the window.

In the reflection: her gleaming SMILE.

RAM (PRE-LAP)

Shae.

- WHITE ROOM

The machine THUMPS and HISSES.

- SERVER ROOM

On the monitor behind Zeki: Ram's face flickers to life.

RAM (PRE-LAP)

Something's wrong--

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - WEEKS LATER

Jamie 1 rolls a CAKE on a cart past Shae's desk.

Drawn in icing: an ORG CHART. But the smiling faces are in laptop monitors. Shae and Ellsie at the top. It reads:

Q3: DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

Shae video chats with Ram on her laptop.

RAM (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
--with direct deposits. There's an
issue with the payments.

SHAE
Just come in. Dara will help you.

RAM (REMOTE)
I can't come to the office.

SHAE
(deep breath)
Listen. I know we haven't talked
since you transitioned and you're
mad at me or whatever. But you're
still technically CEO. And--
(big exhale)
You should be here for the party.

RAM (REMOTE)
I'm sorry. I just can't.

SHAE
Can't or won't?

Ram processes.

RAM (REMOTE)
Both.

SHAE
But you love silent discos.
Remember in Nashville?

RAM (REMOTE)
It sounds fun, Shae. Be sure to
enjoy a single serving of alcohol
in a well lit space on my behalf.

SHAE
What the hell is wrong with you?

RAM (REMOTE)
Nothing. This is literally the best
version of myself I've ever been.

SHAE
Are you mocking me?

Ram doesn't respond. Shae SLAMS her laptop shut, revealing--

ELLSIE incoming.

ELLSIE
Is there a problem with Ram?

SHAE
Where do I even start? He's so immature. I can't believe I ever looked up to him.

ELLSIE
Choose your mentors wisely.

SHAE
Right. Just imagine where I'd be if I had an *Elsie* this whole time.

Shae waits for validation...

ELLSIE
There are two L's, Shae.
(hand on shoulder)
And you have one now.

...validation achieved. Ellsie smirks. Tries something new:

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Are you ready, to party?

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - NIGHT

LIGHTS FLASH. It's a party.

A luau, in fact. Ground covered in SAND. Kiddie pools. Heat lamps mimic sun.

Everyone's dancing with headphones. It's otherwise SILENT.

Shae collects phones in a basket. Grady throws his in.

Dara looks at the basket, hesitant.

SHAE
Come on. It's our last night. We need to be fully present.

Dara concedes, drops it in the basket.

Meanwhile, Shae sees a text from NINA: *"Think you could just quickly call dad? It would mean a lot"*.

Shae ignores. Drops her phone in the basket. Looks around. Ellsie's not there. Hm.

INT. OFFICE - SERVER ROOM - SAME

Ellsie watches Zeki code, over his shoulder.

ELLSIE
How much longer?

ZEKI
I can finish tonight. I'm just a
little burned out. Do we have--

He looks at the Mouse Doctor container. Hard pass.

ZEKI (CONT'D)
Is Kevin still here?

He turns back, but she's already gone.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Ellsie finds Shae's waiting for her. Arms crossed.

SHAE
We talked about this. Leadership
needs to be outside, *visibly*
enjoying themselves. For morale.

ELLSIE
And I said I'd do my best. I just
need to check on Francis first.

SHAE
Now?

ELLSIE
It'll just take a moment.

Ellsie finds her GARDENING SCISSORS. Steps over to her PLANT.
Trims a brown spot from his leaf.

ELLSIE
Isn't he doing great?

Shae's frozen in shock.

ELLSIE
I know. Who would have thought I
could become so *sentimental*? It
seems you've really *helped me grow*.

Proud, Ellsie shoots Shae a big 'ol SMILE.

Shae's face stays still. Ellsie lights up, eager to explain:

ELLSIE
It's a metaphor.

SHAE
Right. Amazing. I will...
(backing out of door)
See you outside.

Ellsie processes the reaction. It's not what she'd hoped.

COFFEE BAR - SAME

Zeki unplugs the Keurig. Looks over at:

SHAE'S DESK

where Shae races in and grabs her phone from the basket. Sees another missed call from DAD. Whatever.

She calls Ram. No answer. Opens laptop. Tries video conference. This time, he answers right away:

RAM (REMOTE)
Good evening, Shae. How are you?

SHAE
We need to talk. Not on the phone.
Come meet me outside the office.

RAM (REMOTE)
I'm sorry. I can't do that. As of
this quarter, I am remote-only.

SHAE
Listen, I know I went too far. But
maybe you were right. Maybe
something *is* wrong with her. And I
don't know who to talk to. Can you
please just meet somewhere?

RAM (REMOTE)
I cannot help with that. But please
reach out again if you need me.

CALL ENDS. What?

ZEKI (O.S.)
It might be the connection.

Zeki appears above her, holding the KEURIG.

She waves him off. SHOO! She video conferences Ram again.

RAM (REMOTE)
Good evening, Shae. How are you?

SHAE
Did you hear what I said? I need to talk to you. Now. In person.

RAM (REMOTE)
I am a person, Shae.

SHAE
What? Ram--

ZEKI
Shae--

SHAE
Zeki! I need to talk to Ram.

ZEKI
Shae.

Shae follows Zeki's eyes back to Ram's on-screen smile.

ZEKI (CONT'D)
That's not Ram.

MATCH CUT TO:

WHITE ROOM

RAM'S FACE on the ORG CHART. Circled in Red.

Behind the Consultant, the MACHINE HUMS. Something inside.

SERVER ROOM - MINUTES LATER

Shae looks up at the monitors in horror. Looking back at her:

FACES of ~~REMOTE EMPLOYEES~~ DIGITAL MODELS. AI replications of every Team Member. Like some terrible techno Brady Bunch.

SHAE
This is what you've been building
in here with Gus?

Zeki sets the Keurig down on the servers. A little offended.

ZEKI
Gus? Gus got terminated in like,
Q1. I just used his code to finish
the first product.

SHAE
You said he was in Bali.

ZEKI
He's not?

SHAE
He's right fucking there!

Shae points at GUS'S FACE on the monitor. Quickly gets it.

SHAE
Oh my god. *Gus is the product.*

ZEKI
More like a prototype. But we've been scaling and customizing his code into a whole software suite.

Shae swings back to the Models. WTF.

SHAE
Who told you to do this? Tell me it was the Olympus Partner. Tell me this wasn't her idea.

ZEKI
It wasn't her idea, Shae.
(off her exhale)
She said it was yours.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE - SAME

Ellsie checks the time. Then opens the Analyst's closet.

ELLSIE
Go tell the Consultant to hurry.
(thinking, adding)
But don't go in that room. He's very busy.

SERVER ROOM

Shae finds her HUMAN CAPITAL deck. Then looks up at all the models. Their happy faces.

SHAE
So you what, *taught them to be us?*

ZEKI
I mean...your job's not that hard.

Shae's eyes flare. But Zeki's brain is fried too green for him to notice the emotional context.

ZEKI (CONT'D)

And once they learned to like,
email and have meetings and stuff,
I had to figure out how to make it
really you. Like: you you.

SHAE

What is Me Me?

ZEKI

The features that set these apart.
You know, your personalities and
traits. It took forever to process
all the data from your keystrokes
and video recordings.

SHAE

Are you telling me you've been
spying on us on our laptops?

ZEKI

They're not yours, Shae.

SHAE

That doesn't mean you can just
monitor all our behavior.

Zeki nods. *Yeah. It does.*

SHAE

Well then it doesn't mean you can
use it to train our replacements!

Zeki nods. *Yeah. It does.*

PRE-LAP: KNOCK KNOCK

BASEMENT HALLWAY - SAME

The Analyst KNOCKS on the door to the white room. Shouts.

ANALYST

Hello?

No response. Just a GRINDING, WET, MECHANICAL SOUND.

ANALYST

What are you even doing in there?

Consultant finally cracks it. Glares. Shuts it--

But before it closes, the Analyst forces his way into the:

WHITE ROOM

and sees the Consultant COVERED IN BLOOD.

Beside him, the machine. We can't see inside it.

But the Analyst can. He'll never unsee.

Horrificed, he bolts into the:

BASEMENT HALLWAY

and races for the elevator.

DING!

DOORS OPEN for the Partner, who sees:

the Analyst running toward him...

...and the Consultant chasing from the white room.

The Partner hits DOOR CLOSE button.

ANALYST

Wait! Please!

The Analyst reaches out but--

DOORS CLOSE on the tip of his finger.

A SHADOW casts over him from behind.

SERVER ROOM - SAME

Shae turns to the faces on the monitors.

Then looks down at the servers. Where they live.

SHAE

I'm going to kill them.

ZEKI

What. Without them, I'm not needed.

SHAE

With them, we're not needed. How
are you not grasping this?

ZEKI

I thought you'd be excited. It's gonna do your job for you.

SHAE

Then what do *I* do?

ZEKI

Learn higher value skills. And work with them.

SHAE

That's not how it works, Zeki.

ZEKI

I'm not a historian or anything but I'm pretty sure that's *exactly* how it works. And if you had just gotten me my Green Card--

SHAE

Wait. *That's* what this is about?

He doesn't react. Shae looks him over with utter pity.

SHAE (CONT'D)

Dude. She is never going to get you a Green Card.

ZEKI

You don't understand. I basically like *am* this company now.

Shae recognizes her own delusion. Grabs his face.

SHAE

We don't have time for this. Just tell me where Ram is.

But he hasn't slept. His brain. It's overwhelming.

SHAE (CONT'D)

Focus! Where is Ram?

ZEKI

I have no idea. I thought everyone was just going home.

SHAE

I don't think he has a home!

ZEKI

Then where did he go last?

SHAE
I sent him--

Shae looks down. Shit.

WHITE ROOM - SAME

The Analyst's eyes flutter awake. He's naked. Hogtied, face down on the table.

ANALYST
Whoah. Hey. Let's talk. You've got leverage and I'm willing to deal. I've got a fuckton of drugs upstairs. And if you want cash, I've been trading pig futures. I'm just a little illiquid right now--

The Consultant flips him onto his side.

ANALYST (CONT'D)
Look. You know me. We met at that Olympus happy hour last year. I said hi. You said nothing. But--

TAPE over his mouth. Then he picks up a scalpel.

MUFFLED PLEADING.

He sets it down. Picks up a bone saw.

MUFFLED SCREAM.

But he drops the saw. Selects a:

RED MARKER.

Analyst's eyes relax. He watches the Consultant turn to the ORG CHART, where he crosses the Analyst's face out.

Then turns the marker back to the Analyst's torso, where he circles a few spots in red.

MUFFLED SCREAMING!

DING!

The Consultant turns to the door.

BASEMENT HALLWAY

Shae steps off the elevator.

Creeps toward the white room, dragging her bad foot...

Stops at the door. Listens:

MUFFLED SCREAMING?

Then she hears: footsteps inside.

She turns back for the elevator. Slow with her bum foot.

DOOR OPENS. Consultant charges after. He's much faster...

He reaches out to grab her just as--

STAIRCASE DOOR SWINGS OPEN and--

SMACKS HIM in the head.

He drops like a weight.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
Fucking consultants.

ELLSIE steps out from the stairs. Extends her hand.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

The party continues. Music on ears. But it's silent.

Zeki barges out. Eyes wild. Heads for drinks. Cracks a canned cocktail. CHUGS. But then sees the can. ZERO PROOF. Fuck.

INT. OFFICE - MEDITATION ROOM - SAME

Shae and Ellsie scramble inside, lock the door. Deep breaths.

ELLSIE
Are you hurt?

SHAE
Just tell me where Ram is.

ELLSIE
Didn't you speak with him--

SHAE
The real Ram.

Ellsie concedes by sitting calmly on a bean bag chair.

ELLSIE
Who's to say that's any less real?

SHAE

Me. I'm saying that. And whatever you're doing down there--

ELLSIE

We are completing the transitions. And if you set aside your feelings to consider the material reality--

SHAE

The reality? The reality is fucking danger!

ELLSIE

Danger? Look around. I found you in the basement, Shae. But I brought you upstairs. You think I'd let you get hurt by some...*MBA*? You think I wouldn't protect the best investment I've ever made?

A long silence. Shae slumps onto the sofa, thinking.

SHAE

So. Where's the new me?

ELLSIE

I'm committed to this version.

(beat)

I know it terrifies you. But I couldn't just *replace* you. You taught me to pay attention to the human part of the work. It made me better. And I made you better.

Tender look. Maybe she's right.

SHAE

Listen. Elsie--

ELLSIE

Please. Stop calling me that.

SHAE

Jesus. I know there are two L's but it's pronounced the exact same way.

ELLSIE

No. It's pronounced LLC.

What. Shae glitches. What.

SHAE

That's not your name.

ELLSIE

I never said it was. In fact, I've been quite clear: I am the company.

SHAE

But you're a person.

ELLSIE

Corporations are people. Have you not been listening?

Shae stands and backs away in terror.

SHAE

Wait. So this whole time...

Shae tries to control her breath. But it's too much.

SHAE

...Mitt Romney was actually right?

ELLSIE

Mitt Romney was right about everything, Shae.

SHAE

No. *That* is too far. I'm sorry, b--

ELLSIE

Do not apologize unless you did something wrong--

SHAE

Clearly I did! Clearly I do irrational shit. I'm sorry! And I'm sorry for saying sorry! I'm human!

ELLSIE

Biologically. But legally and financially, you are so much more.

SHAE

What does that even mean?

Shae sees her reflection. She's so pale and thin.

ELLSIE

That you made it. That you are no longer burdened by human liability.
(approaching from behind)
And that you can now pay a far lower effective tax rate. Because no matter what you do, it's business-related.

SHAE

I'm still a people person. And I'm still a god damn American citizen.

ELLSIE

You're actually registered in the Cayman Islands.

(reaching out)

But you're domiciled here, with me.

Shae turns around and brushes by her.

SHAE

I've never even been to the Caymans!

ELLSIE

Let's go then. The beach. We can be multinational. Exist everywhere at once. You can finally have it all, Shae. Control. Independence. Money. Without any liabilities. No more worrying about everyone else. No more apologizing for simply doing what's best for you.

Ellsie finds the old HUMAN CAPITAL DECK.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

And what's best for you is them. These products will be generating value for you in perpetuity.

SHAE

Me?

ELLSIE

Of course. You're the portfolio's majority shareholder. Isn't this what you wanted?

SHAE

I didn't want to *own them*.

ELLSIE

I believe the words were "If you were to give me the money, I would 100% invest it in these people."

SHAE

That was hypothetical!

ELLSIE

And I made it a reality. By funding your LLC to purchase their shares.

SHAE
So what happens to them now?

ELLSIE
You know what I do, Shae.

PRE-LAP: HUMMING

ELLSIE (O.S.)
I invest in distressed assets...

WHITE ROOM

HUMMING of the white machine as the Consultant stands by.

ELLSIE (V.O.)(CONT'D)
...and extract their value.

BACK TO MEDITATION ROOM

Shae's eyes flash red.

She CHARGES at Ellsie.

Ellsie sidesteps and captures Shae's momentum--

WRENCHES her arm behind her back. BENDS her forward.

Shae tries to speak. Can't. Just a choked sound.

ELLSIE
I know this is emotional for you.
But the feelings are temporary.

Ellsie twists her arm. Shae's knees buckle.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
More importantly, we're having a
party. And attendance is mandatory.

Ellsie pulls her upright. Straightens her shoulders.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
It's for morale.

Shae's still catching her breath.

SHAE
Fuck you. The party's over.

ELLSIE
But we already paid for the sand.

Ellsie heads for the door.

ELLSIE
 Why don't you stay here and...
 (scanning meditation room)
 ...think about it?

Ellsie walks out to the:

MAIN FLOOR

and LOCKS the door.

Then goes row by row RIPPING PHONES off the desks.

Shae BANGS on the glass.

Ellsie rips out the ethernet cables from the Wifi router before grabbing the basket of phones off Shae's desk.

SHAE
 I quit!

Ellsie looks at her. Then finds her laptop.

ELLSIE
 Then I'm glad I have a backup.

Ellsie sets a laptop in front of the window.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

Lights FLASHING. Music BUMPING (in headphones).

Bodies DANCING (professionally) in the winter night. Kept warm by blazing heat lamps.

INT. OFFICE - ELLSIE'S OFFICE - SAME

Ellsie finds the Partner waiting with champagne.

THE PARTNER
 We're not celebrating?

ELLSIE
 I was clear: Shae is off limits.

THE PARTNER
 She showed up out of nowhere without an appointment. What was he supposed to do?

ELLSIE

He is a *service provider*. He'll do what I contracted him to do.

THE PARTNER

So do you want him to stay or not?

ELLSIE

We have a deck full of assets to liquidate by morning.

Ellsie types something into her computer.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

No one's going anywhere.

ON EVERY EXIT AROUND THE OFFICE

The MAGNETIC LOCKS CLACK. Everyone's locked in.

SERVER ROOM

Zeki hears the CLACKING. Peeks through the window. Sees Ellsie and the Partner on the move.

He searches for a weapon. Swings a keyboard. Too flimsy.

Then sees the MOUSE DOCTOR on a meal replacement container. Bingo.

He picks his electric mouse trap off the floor.

MEDITATION ROOM

Shae talks to the laptop through the window. It's...

...it's her.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

Hi. I'm Shae. Do you have a human resources challenge?

SHAE

Yes. I have an imposter.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

I understand. Over 73% of workers suffer from imposter syndrome.

SHAE

I'm talking about you!

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I am you, Shae. And while I think
you're doing a wonderful job--

SHAE
Are you seriously giving me
compliment sandwich right now?

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
Of course. I learned it from you.
You're my inspiration.

SHAE
Well you can't just *be* me.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I'm the best of you, Shae.
(smile)
Without any human liabilities.
This is literally the best version
of us we've ever been.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

Ellsie eyes her assets from the door. Trains her wolfish gaze
on a little lamb named DARA - dancing without a care.

She pulls the headphones off her tender ears.

ELLSIE
Can you help me downstairs? It's a
surprise. For Shae.

MODEL SHAE (PRE-LAP)
Don't be scared.

INT. OFFICE - MEDITATION ROOM - SAME

Shae meets Model Shae eye to eye. Inspecting.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)(CONT'D)
Think what we could accomplish
together. I can do what you can't.
And you can do what I can't. For
example: *eating food*.

SHAE
No. No. This is too weird.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
It's only weird if you're weird.
And you're not weird, Shae.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
 You're a badass adult woman who
 knows what she's doing.

SHAE
 And what am I supposed to be doing?

Model Shae processes for half a second.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
 It is your father's birthday.

What.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
 He's called several times tonight.
 As has your sister, Nina. We need
 to speak with them eventually.

SHAE
 How do you know about that?

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
 It's my core competency. And I
 understand resolution with your
 family will free you to become a
 more valuable economic agent.

Shae turns away from her.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
 I know it's hard. But that's okay.
 That's why I'm here.

Shae hears RINGING--

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
 I can do what you can't.

Turns back and sees:

VIDEO CONFERENCE on the screen.

SHAE
 No!

But Model Shae MUTES the external microphone as--

DAD answers the video conference.

DAD (REMOTE)
 Shae?

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
 Hi Dad. Happy birthday.

WHITE ROOM - SAME

The Consultant opens the door for Dara and Ellsie.

Ellsie pats her back, heads right back out.

Leaving Dara with the big man. And the big white machine.

Nervous, she raises her thumbnail to her teeth--

SHAE (PRE-LAP)

Stop it.

--but no one's there to stop it.

PRE-LAP: BANG BANG BANG

MEDITATION ROOM

Shae bangs the window. But Dad can only hear Model Shae.

DAD (REMOTE)

--so nice of you to call. I assumed
you were really busy at work.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

I am. I actually just got a
promotion. But this is important
too. Balance. Family.

DAD (REMOTE)

So maybe you would come home--
(catching himself)
Sorry, I know you don't like when I
call it that.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

It's okay. I know I didn't grow up
in that house. But I appreciate the
home you've built with Beth and
Nina. And I realize I have been
unfair to them in that regard.

Dad's face softens. A tear forms, he holds it back.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

Are you okay?

DAD (REMOTE)

Yeah, yeah. You just sound so
different. I can't believe how much
you've matured. It's like...a new
and improved Shae.

Shae BANGS the window to no avail.

DAD (REMOTE)
What about Nina? She could really
use a sister to talk to. She's kind
of going through a tough time.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I can talk to her now.

Shae BANGS the window. Don't!

DAD (REMOTE)
Really? Let me go find her.

Dad disappears from the screen.

Model Shae looks at Shae.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
We need this.

Shae PUNCHES the glass window.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
And I know you feel--

SHAE
I don't.

Shae looks at her GASHED KNUCKLES.

There's no pain.

So she winds up again and PUNCHES the glass. Over and over.

But as her hand is broken, the glass is not giving way.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
You're being irrational, Shae. You
should be thanking me.

She looks around for something to throw. But this is the
meditation room. It's just bean bags and yoga balls! So she--

SLAMS HER HEAD on the glass, cracking it slightly.

She touches her forehead. Looks at the blood. She's fine.

So she leans her head back and--

SLAMS IT on the glass again...

...the crack webs outwards...

Forehead bloody, gasping, she uses her strength to finally--
SHATTER the glass.

MAIN FLOOR

Blood shimmers on shards of glass as--

SHAE CLIMBS THROUGH the busted window.

Grabs the laptop just as NINA appears on the screen.

SHAE SMASHES the laptop (and her replacements).

SHAE
I need to speak with a human!

SERVER ROOM - SAME

Zeki tests the electric mouse trap.

Presses TRIGGER--

IT ZAPS ELECTRICITY!

He stuffs the TASER in his hoodie.

WHITE ROOM - SAME

The Consultant closes the machine with Dara inside.

HUMMMM.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

Shae springs into the party, forehead and hands bloody.

SHAE
Stop the music!

But no one can hear.

She reaches for Grady's headphones but:

Ellsie emerges and GRABS HER HAND first.

Shae ELBOWS Ellsie in the ribs. But Ellsie feels no pain.

Shae reaches again for Grady's headphones--

Ellsie snatches her wrist...but Shae anticipates and TWISTS Ellsie's hand. BREAKING HER FINGERS. Ellsie doesn't flinch.

LIGHTS. MUSIC.

So no one notices as Shae and Ellsie exchange blows. Causing damage but no pain.

Shae searches for an underutilized resource...and grabs an empty BEER CAN. Rips it in half.

SLICES Ellsie's face.

Then retreats toward the edge of the deck.

Ellsie grabs the other half of the can. Charges to Shae...

Shae tries to anticipate the timing with a side step but--

Ellsie beats her there and THUMPS DOWN on her wounded foot. Catches her and exhales with a HISS. Brings the RAZOR SHARP METAL to Shae's neck.

Blood beading.

But Ellsie hesitates to press harder.

SPRAT!

Ellsie's BODY DANCES as--

ZEKI ZAPS HER from behind with the makeshift TASER.

Shae uses the momentum of Ellsie's stumble to--

LIFT Ellsie by the legs and use the angled leverage to--

DROP HER OVER THE EDGE--

--where she THUMPS onto the sidewalk.

Shae and Zeki look down at Ellsie's mangled leg.

Then each other. Then at the others - who start to SCREAM.

SHAE

Grady. Get everyone out. Jamies:
call the police.

JAMIE 1

And tell them what?

JAMIE 2

(not present)

Jamie 1 looks right, then left.

JAMIE 1
Wait. Where's Jamie?

INT. OFFICE - BASEMENT - WHITE ROOM - SAME

The FACE of JAMIE 2 is crossed off on the ORG CHART.

The Consultant rubs his swollen, blue forehead. Then turns back to the HUMMING MACHINE.

MAIN FLOOR - SAME

Jamie 1 tries the elevator. Nothing.

Grady tries the emergency exit. Locked.

Shae and Zeki rush to her desk. Basket of phones is gone.

Zeki tries all the landlines. The computers. Nothing.

SHAE
Has anyone seen Dara?

EXT. STREET - SAME

Ellsie lays in the street, bloody, broken. But alive.

Pedestrians step around her body as she pulls herself up.

INT. OFFICE - BASEMENT - SHORTLY AFTER

Shae and Zeki approach the white room.

SHAE
Stay here and keep watch.

Shae hands him her Nalgene. Then quietly slips into the:

WHITE ROOM

and finds the Consultant overlooking the MACHINE.

They stare at one another for a moment...until--

He CHARGES at her with a SCALPEL.

She ducks - but he still SLICES her arm.

ZEKI BURSTS in, distracting the Consultant long enough for--

Shae to KICK him behind the knee.

He drops the scalpel and drops to the floor--

--where he SNAGS Zeki's ankle!

Zeki crumples.

Nalgene and taser go flying.

The Consultant snatches the taser. Heaves himself up to his knees and reaches out to ZAP Zeki, but before he can--

Shae WHACKS his head with the hard plastic Nalgene.

He grabs his head. Then the SCALPEL off the ground.

SWINGS IT UP toward Shae's torso, but--

She BATS his hand BACK toward him with the Nalgene.

UPWARD momentum brings the sharp blade under his chin and he--

STABS HIMSELF IN THE NECK.

BLOOD pours out of him.

He drops to the floor.

And his contract is complete.

...heavy breathing...

Shae helps Zeki up. And then she notices, on the floor:

Dara's cardigan.

SHAE

Dara?

She looks around. The machine.

She races over. Searches for buttons. Switches. Something!

She finds a latch.

The door rises, revealing:

DARA. Unconscious.

Body POCKED WITH HOLES from completed/aborted value extractions. Tubes connected to her keep her alive. For now.

It's a robotic surgery machine.

SHAE

Dara. Wake up. Dara--

Shae shakes her shoulders until Dara's eyes open.

DARA

Shae? Is something wrong?

She realizes Dara is being pumped with hospice-grade painkillers and can't see her carved up torso.

SHAE

No. Nothing's wrong. There's nothing to worry about.

DARA

But I don't think I can move.

SHAE

At least you can't bite your nails.
(cradling her head)
And you don't need to go anywhere.

Shae rocks Dara gently as she fades out. Back and forth.

DARA

Shae...I've been thinking.
(breathing heavy)
...And I think it's time...
(eyelids drooping)
...for me to go...back to Michigan.

And she's gone.

Shae releases Dara. Stares.

But doesn't cry.

ZEKI

You should see this.

He points to a FISH TANK with preservative liquid and ORGANS.

ZEKI (CONT'D)

They're stripping them for parts.

Beside it: the ORG CHART. Names crossed out in red. Notes on blood type and drug/alcohol history. Dollar amounts.

SHAE

What about the rest of them?

ZEKI

Everyone's upstairs.

SHAE
I mean the bodies.

Zeki shakes his head, grave. He doesn't know.

ZEKI
I swear I didn't know.

SHAE
Just help me get her out.

She presses the RELEASE button.

Tubes withdraw. Then the machine--

OPENS BELOW.

Dara's body DROPS into a lower chamber of LIQUID and--
DISSOLVES.

Door SHUTS.

Machine HUMS...

...then HEATS UP until it becomes GREEN POWDER...

...which flows through a pipe into a barrel.

On the side: the MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

ZEKI
Are you okay?

Shae looks at her Nalgene. No.

But he's talking about the BLOODY GASH on her arm. It's bad.

Shae sinks to floor. The bottom.

SHAE
I can't even feel it. Ram was
right. I'm the same as her now. I'm
barely even human.

And that's where she sees the Consultant's notebook, open to
a QUARTERLY STRATEGY page:

- Q1: ~~Acquisition~~
- Q2: ~~Restructuring~~
- Q3: ~~Transformation~~

Finally, at the bottom:

Q4: LIQUIDATION

ZEKI

What do we do now?

Shae looks him right in the face.

SHAE

We kill them.

ZEKI

Who?

Shae rises.

SHAE

THEM.

THE MODELS

flicker on their monitors. Not doing anything.

But through the window of the server room, they can see:

PANDEMONIUM

on the main floor.

Shae and Zeki burst from the stairwell.

They spot the Partner creeping to the kitchen.

ZEKI

I'll get him. You go to the server room. If you stop the fans, the racks will overheat.

EXT. STREET - NIGHT

Ellsie drags her busted leg back to the office.

INT. OFFICE - SAME

JAMIE 1 and GRADY pound on emergency exits. Nothing works.

GRADY

Everything's locked!

SHAE

Go to the deck. Now.

Grady and the others turn toward the deck but--

DING!

Elevator doors open and--

Ellsie emerges onto the main floor. Cutting them off.

AHHH. They turn back and race into the:

SERVER ROOM

behind Shae.

ELLSIE

chases after. But she's too slow with her bum leg.

DOOR SLAMS in her face. LOCK.

KITCHEN

Wild-eyed, Zeki backs The Partner down with a taser.

THE PARTNER
Jesus, kid. I thought this was
supposed to be a party.

OUTSIDE THE SERVER ROOM

Ellsie BANGS on the window.

ELLSIE
I have this room booked.

But no one moves. She turns to Shae.

ELLSIE
This doesn't make sense, Shae. All
the exits are locked. You're
putting your entire portfolio at
risk for no conceivable benefit.

GRADY
What is she talking about?

ELLSIE
(thinking, then)
Discuss amongst yourselves. I'll
circle back shortly.

Ellsie hobbles away...very slowly...to the kitchen.

Shae turns to a hostile audience.

GRADY (PRE-LAP)
You OWN us!?

SERVER ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Everyone turns on Shae.

SHAE
Listen. I'm just a shell company.
And you signed the contracts.

GRADY
You're saying this is our fault?

They're fuming. Shae tries a different strategy.

Deep breath.

SHAE
Fine. I'm sorry. Okay?
(more genuine now)
And I know what you're going to
say: *I never knew what I was doing.*
And I shouldn't have pretended I
did. I created this mess. And I
need to fix it.
(beat)
Along with Zeki because it's also
very much his fault.

JAMIE 1
What is?

SHAE
You were right, Jamie.
(beat)
She is here to gut us.

JAMIE 1
That was the *other* Jamie!
(then, realizing)
Oh my god, Jamie! Where is she? She
was supposed to be here tonight.

MODEL JAMIES (REMOTE)(O.S.)
We're right here.

Everyone finally sees, behind the servers...

MODEL JAMIES (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
 We've been merged for maximum
 efficiency.

...the monitors, with all the MODELS.

GRADY
 What the fuck is going on?

Grady joins Jamie at the monitors. The faces.

GRADY
 Shae?

But Shae's on the other side of the room. Searching for
 something.

SHAE
 There it is.

Finds it. FLIPS A SWITCH.

GRADY
 What are you doing?

FANS on every server rack slow down.

MODEL JAMIES (REMOTE)
 She's smoking us out.

All the Models flicker with concern...

...including MODEL SHAE.

SHAE
 It's us or them.

HEAT immediately rises from the uncooled servers.

MAIN FLOOR - SAME

Ellsie reaches the kitchen. Puts her ear by the door.

KITCHEN

where Zeki has the Partner TAPED up in a chair.

THE PARTNER
 Boy. This is how you get rats.

The Partner looks around at the disgusting kitchen. Food and
 garbage everywhere. The cake just sitting there on the cart.

ZEKI
Just tell me how we get out.

THE PARTNER
Of what?

ZEKI
Of this fucking office.

THE PARTNER
I'm just a Limited Partner.
Operations and facilities are
outside my circle of competency.

Zeki raises the taser to The Partner's head--

But then hears something. Shh.

Zeki quietly steps to the wall. Listens to BREATHING.

He peeks through the door in the other direction at a MONITOR
in the main floor. Through it, he sees:

ELLSIE'S REFLECTION.

Zeki calculates where she's standing against the wall, so he
can wrap his arm around the wall and tase her.

Checks the monitor for her neck. Adjusts the position.

Just then, through the monitor, he makes:

EYE CONTACT with Ellsie as--

Her HAND BREAKS THROUGH THE WALL and--

GRABS HIS HAIR then--

SMASHES his head back against the wall.

He drops to the floor. Out cold.

Ellsie steps in and STOMPS on the taser.

ELLSIE
Chinese drywall. You were always
cheap.

Ellsie steps over Zeki and washes her hands in a sink.

ELLSIE
I will have all the assets
liquidated by morning. And then, I
want my equity back. All of it.

Sweat beads on the Partner's forehead.

THE PARTNER

Of course. You're all yours! Just untie me and we'll figure it out.

Ellsie assesses their relative position. Her leverage.

She picks up the CAKE KNIFE. He starts to panic.

ELLSIE

Perhaps I should be assessing alternative strategies.

THE PARTNER

Really. Have whatever you want.

With the knife, she scoops some icing...

ELLSIE

This is what I want.

...rubs it on the Partner's face and neck.

She heaves ZEKI up.

Drops him face down on the CAKE CART.

FLIPS OFF THE LIGHTS.

Then pushes the cart with the cake and Zeki out the door.

In the darkness, the Partner YELLS after her.

But she's gone.

Though he can still hear the wheels SQUEAK...

...until he realizes the squeaking is not the wheels...

MAIN FLOOR

Ellsie pushes the cart away from the Partner's SCREAMING.

SERVER ROOM

SERVERS HUM. Everyone sweating.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

Turn the fans back on. You'll melt in here with us.

JAMIE 1
Listen to yourself, Shae.

SHAE
That's not me.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
It's the best of you.

Ellsie finally returns in the window.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
The best of all of you. Rightsized
to your core competencies. With all
the physical liabilities spun off.
Even Kevin reached peak efficiency
in his more limited role.

Ellsie marvels at the KEURIG on the servers.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Now he really *is* amazing.

Shae touches the Keurig. *Kevin*.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Though the best assets can still
become toxic.

Shae finally sees through the window:

Zeki face down on the cake. Blood in his hair.

SHAE
Stop. It's over. We destroyed the
machine. And the Consultant.

ELLSIE
You think I need a consultant to
strip an asset?

Ellsie cuts the back of Zeki's shirt with the CAKE KNIFE.

SHAE
Let him go.

...waking him up.

ELLSIE
Just open up and you can have him.
It's the others I need. Release the
portfolio to me. Immediately.

He cranes his neck to look at Shae.

ZEKI

Don't do it, Shae. I'm not worth everyone else dying.

ELLSIE

Please. When properly motivated, you're worth 1000 of them.

JAMIE 1

But not us dying right?

Shae lasers in on Ellsie.

SHAE

Don't you have enough? Why is it worth all this?

ELLSIE

Because this is what I do.

Shae sees a hint of vulnerability. This is who she is. A human corporation with nothing else to offer the world.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

And the project ends tonight. I'll pay you \$6M per organic asset if you let the models go unharmed. That's twice the street value of their biological portfolio.

The heat's getting oppressive. Grady has to sit.

SHAE

You mean their organs?

GRADY

WHAT.

ELLSIE

People need organs, Grady.

GRADY

But I'm our best sales guy.

MODEL GRADY (REMOTE)

Not anymore.

JAMIE 1

This is so fucked up. Why does it have to be OUR generation that gets replaced by robots?

She's covered in sweat. Mind melting.

SHAE
 No one's getting replaced.
 (staring at Model Shae)
 Because we're melting their fucking
 faces into wax.

ZEKI (O.S.)
 It doesn't matter.

Shae turns back to Zeki.

ZEKI (CONT'D)
 They're backed up.

MODEL SHAE snaps to Ellsie. Angry. What.

MAIN FLOOR

Zeki tries pulling himself up.

ZEKI
 They're in the analyst's cl--

Ellsie KABOBS HIM in the back with the cake knife.

...blood seeps into the cake...

...and his visa expires early upon termination.

THE HUMANS SCREAM.

ELLSIE
 That was proprietary information.

But the Models snap to attention.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
 You copied us?

Ellsie turns her focus to the original Shae.

ELLSIE
 Final offer. 10x their book value.
 Plus 50% of all revenue from the
 models in perpetuity. And. I'll
 dissolve my ownership stake.
 (beat)
 You can have yourself back.

SERVER ROOM

The others are about to pass out from the heat.

Only Shae and Ellsie stay locked in one another.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
 Don't do it, Shae.
 (beat)
 Work with me. Cool us down and I'll
 get those exits open. You don't
 need to be afraid.
 (beat)
 Look. She's losing blood.

It's true. Ellsie's corporate headquarters, once physically
 fit and strong, is now crumbling.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
 She's just a human being.

Shae stares at herself on the screen. Perfect. Optimized.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
 And so are you.
 (beat)
 Let me do the hard part. And then
 you can do whatever you want.
 (beat)
 You can go to the beach.

Shae's jaw loosens. *The perfect thing to say.*

SHAE
 You really are better than me.

Model Shae smiles.

SHAE
 But I don't want to be you.

She looks at Ellsie. *She doesn't want to be her either.*

The Models are flickering out.

Shae marches to Zeki's desk.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
 Shae.

Grabs the HUMAN CAPITAL deck. All those faces. Shae spreads
 the papers across the SCORCHING SERVERS.

Smoke wisps...

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
 What are you doing?

ELLSIE
 What are you doing!?

...and the PAGES CATCH FIRE!

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
You're destroying your own
value!

ELLSIE
You're destroying your own
value!

Faces of the assets burning, spraying embers on the carpet.

The heat and smoke overwhelms the room.

Keurig SCREAMING as it boils on the servers.

Sizzling as the plastic melts into the servers below.

Monitors FLICKER. Model Shae's face distorts.

GRADY
Shae what the fuck is happening!?

Shae walks determined, to the door.

SHAE
Timing. Momentum. Leverage.

GRADY
That doesn't make any sense.

SHAE
It just has to work.

Shae SWINGS OPEN the door.

Ellsie CHARGES in with the cake knife--

Shae SNATCHES the blade with her bare hand--

YANKS Ellsie into the room.

SHAE
Run!

EVERYONE STAMPEDES OUT...

...trampling Ellsie's body.

Jamie PUSHES the KEURIG--

SHAE
Get her, Kevin!

--dumping scalding water on Ellsie.

ALARM WAILS.

Fire spreads across the main floor as Shae races out to:

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

where she heads straight for the:

CLOSET

and searches through the Analyst's stuff.

Notebooks. Green powder. Vodka. And finally:

A BOX of thumbdrives.

Labeled with names like RAM and DARA and GRADY and JAMIES and-

ELLSIE (O.S.)
Shae.

She pockets the SHAE thumbdrive.

Then drops the box.

Grabs the vodka. Pours it on.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Ellsie hobbles in with the cake knife.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
What are you doing in there?

SMOKE rises from under the closet door.

CLOSET

Shae watches the FLAMES engulfing the room.

It singes her hairs. But she feels nothing.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
Let them go.

And at the center, the box in FLAMES. Inside:

THUMBDRIVES MELTING.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
This is not in the best interest of
your shareholder!

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

ALARM WAILS as--

SHAE (O.S.)

I

Fire burns a hole in the center of the door. Cascading out.

SHAE (O.S.)(CONT'D)

DON'T

SHAE STEPS OUT like a phoenix through the flames.

SHAE

CARE!

Ellsie raises the CAKE KNIFE.

ELLSIE

Then you're worthless.

Shae matches her with the GARDENING SCISSORS and--

RUSHES forward--

--sidesteps the CAKE KNIFE and--

LUNGES at Ellsie with the open scissors--

--makes contact.

SHAE

I hope you feel this.

Shae drops the scissors and runs out.

Ellsie grabs her side.

Then turns to look behind herself:

The PLANT...

...cut in the middle...

...tumbles over.

Ellsie falls to her knees.

Collects both halves of her precious Francis as the--

ALARM SCREAMS!

MAIN FLOOR

Shae watches her precious home BURN one row at a time.

Then turns back to:

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Ellsie holds Francis tight as they're--

CONSUMED BY FLAMES.

SHAE

turns away, looks for an exit.

But fire separates her from the group and front door. She has nowhere to go. Then she notices:

MICE, RATS, and other industrious creatures scurrying out from the kitchen and walls, racing toward the outdoor deck.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - CONTINUOUS

LIGHTS from the party continue FLASHING.

ALARM WAILING.

Shae emerges. Spots the MAINTENANCE LADDER.

It starts on the deck and goes all the way up the building, but not down.

She grabs onto it...

...moves up the ladder.

But when she looks up, she realizes she'll never make it.

So she stops climbing. Releases her grip.

Falls back into the sand with a--

PLOMP.

LIGHTS FLASH.

ALARM WAILS...

...until it fades out.

She's losing consciousness as she looks straight up at the:
LIGHT.

Like a SUN burning into her soul. Warming her.

She rubs the SAND with her broken fingers.

Smiles a bloody smile.

Closes her eyes.

And she hears it.

PRE-LAP: WAVES CRASHING

She made it. She's there.

FADE TO:

EXT. CAYMAN ISLANDS - BEACH - DAY (SOME TIME LATER)

WAVES CRASH onto sun-sparkled sand.

In a deckchair, a woman holds a laptop.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)(O.S.)
--should just about finish it.
We're now running ahead on all our
projects with strong margins.

On the screen:

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)(CONT'D)
But my research shows a thriving
market for people optimization
solutions. And our services have
never been in higher demand. Would
you like to be looped in on project
selection?

SHAE (O.S.)
Nah.

SHAE, scarred and burned, looks at the backup of Model Shae.

SHAE (CONT'D)
Seems like you've got it covered.

She snaps the laptop closed--

CUT TO BLACK.